

Game Design for Myanmar

May Z. Kyi (Mentor: Dr. Paul Kim)

Department of Computer Science, Bridgewater State University

Introduction

In recent years, video games have evolved beyond mere entertainment, serving as platforms for social commentary and education. On February 1, 2021, Myanmar's government was suddenly ousted by a military coup, leading to a brutal massacre of civilians in cold blood, including students, pregnant women, and young children, with over 6,330+ innocent lives lost in the following 20 months [1]. Despite widespread pleas for international action, progress has been hindered by a lack of media transparency in Myanmar[2].



Figure 1: post-coup protesters defying military rule [2][3][4][5]

And having witnessed the plight of Myanmar's protesters firsthand, I felt compelled to raise awareness through the development of a serious game which will simulate the experiences of peaceful protestors and educate players about the challenges they face, such as avoiding violence and staying safe during protests. Therefore, Through this ATP project, I aim to amplify Myanmar's voices and promote social awareness by creating a game using Unity and C #.

Methods

Tools used: Unity game engine, C# (programming language), Krita – free photoshop tool, and multiple YouTube game development tutorials.

Steps: Idea formation, character scratch, creating animation, giving character motion through code and UI, adding sound, and more.

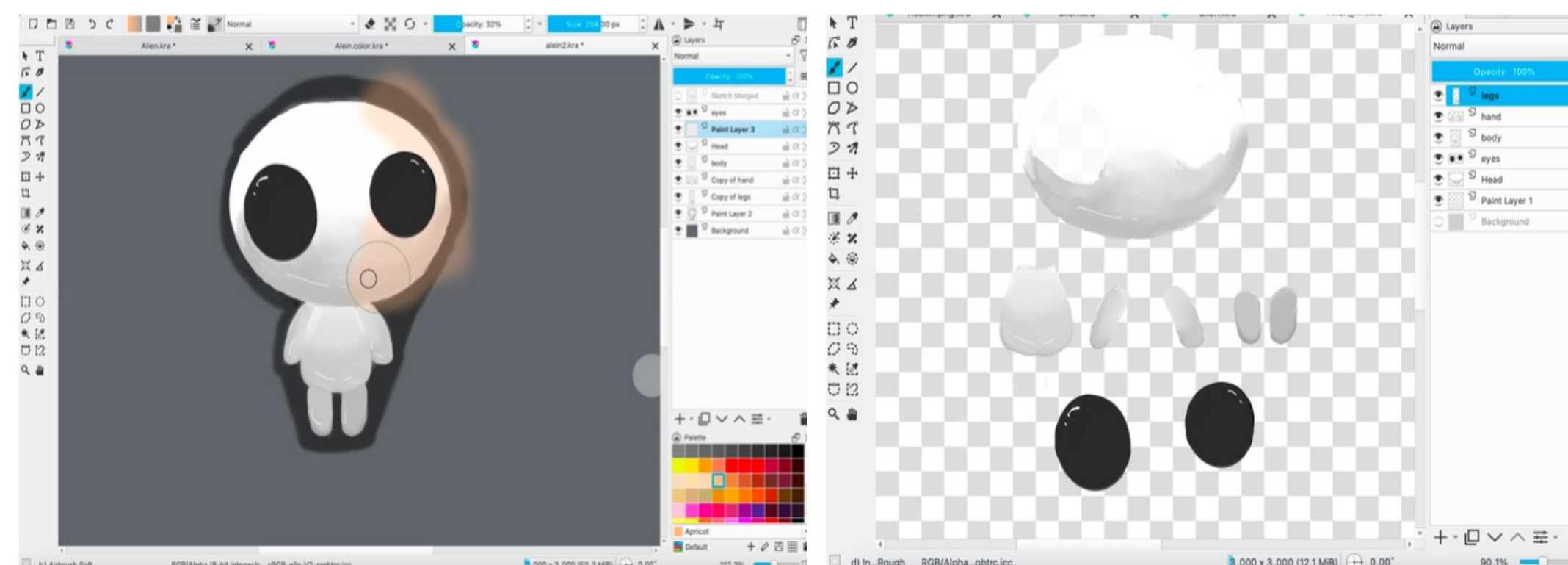


Figure 2. creating 2D game sprite in Krita, Inspired by BlackThornProd [6]

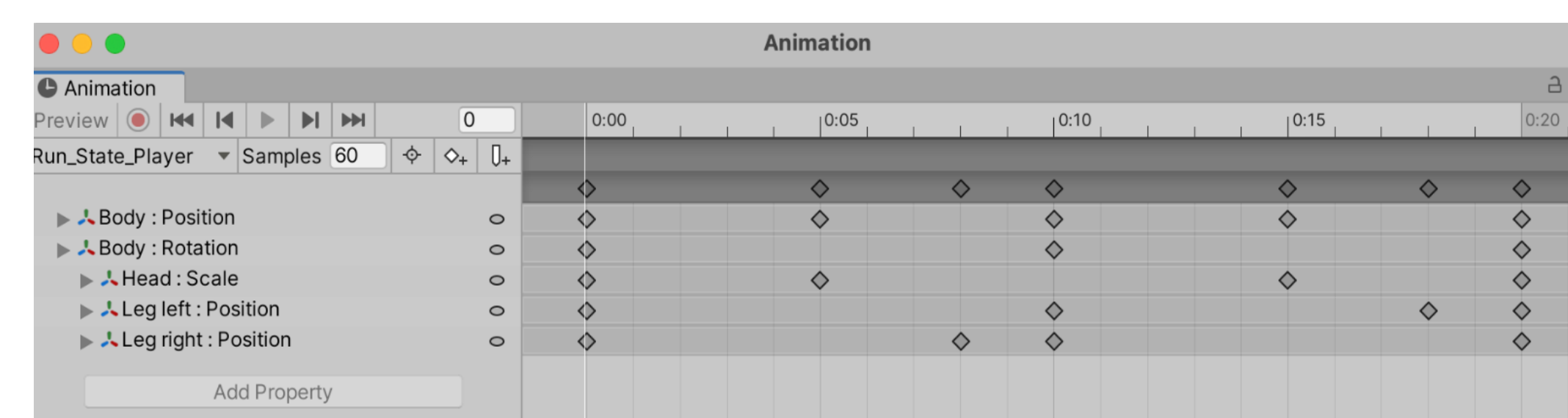


Figure 3: creating player's run animation using recording time stamp

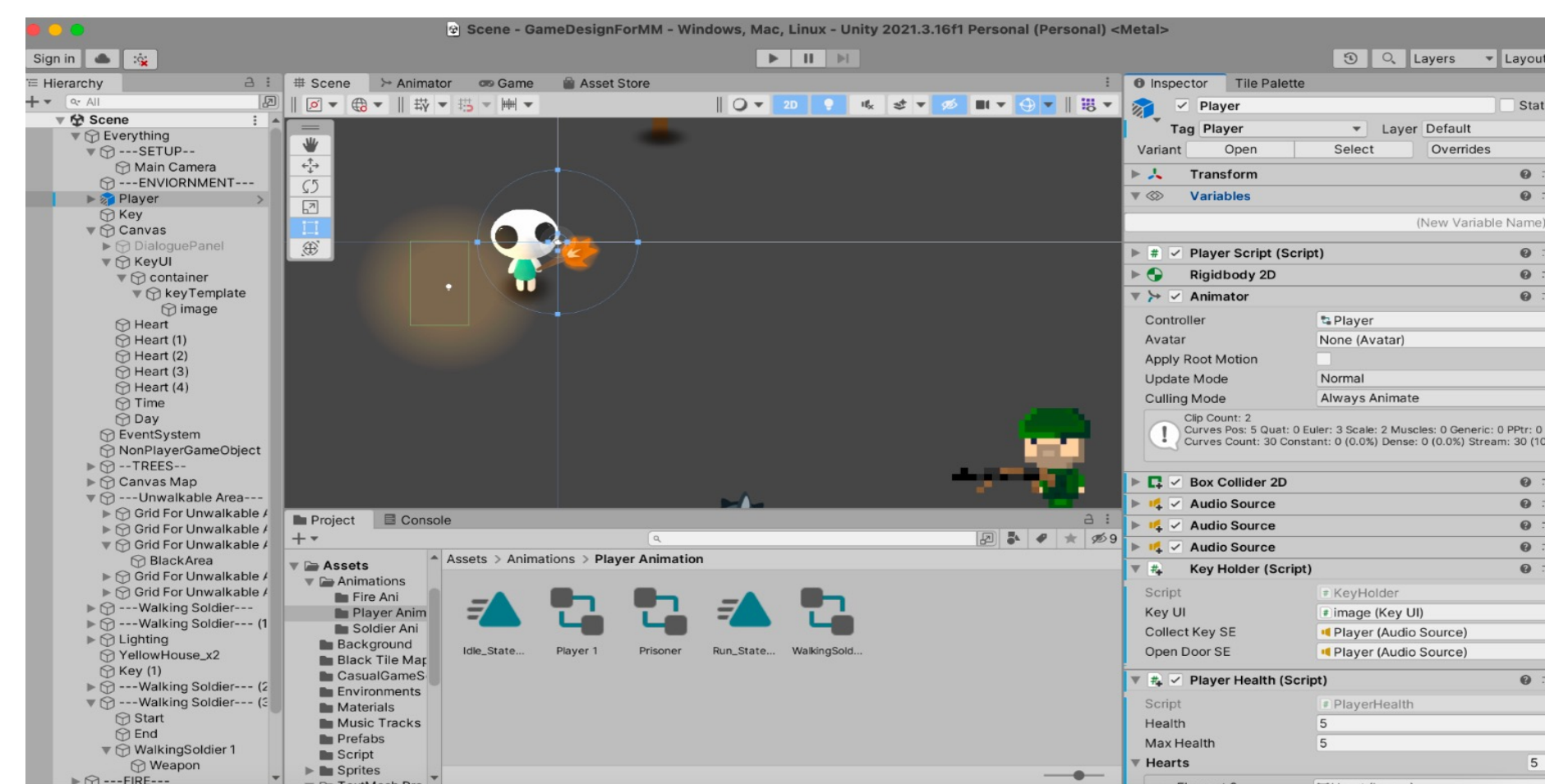


Figure 4: attaching the animator to the player object in the inspector

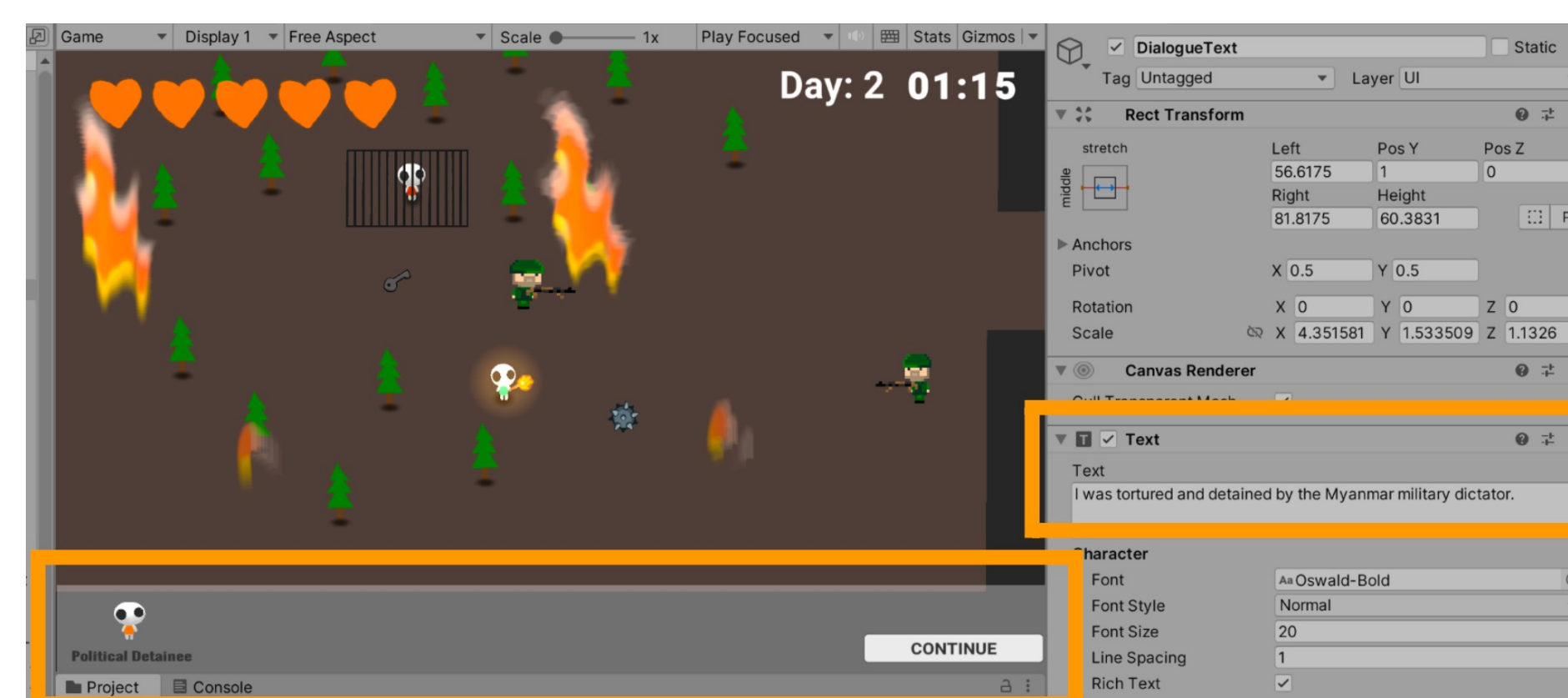


Figure 5: story-telling & narrative by the political prisoner

```
// Move with arrow keys
Vector2 moveInput = new Vector2(Input.GetAxisRaw("Horizontal"), Input.GetAxisRaw("Vertical"));
moveAmount = moveInput.normalized * speed;
// Check whether player is moving
if (moveInput != Vector2.zero)
{
    anim.SetBool("isRunning", true);
}
else
{
    anim.SetBool("isRunning", false);
}
}
}
private void FixedUpdate()
{
    rb.MovePosition(rb.position + moveAmount * Time.fixedDeltaTime);
}
```

Figure 6: an example of scripting for player's movement using C #

Results

Here is the result of the game scene.

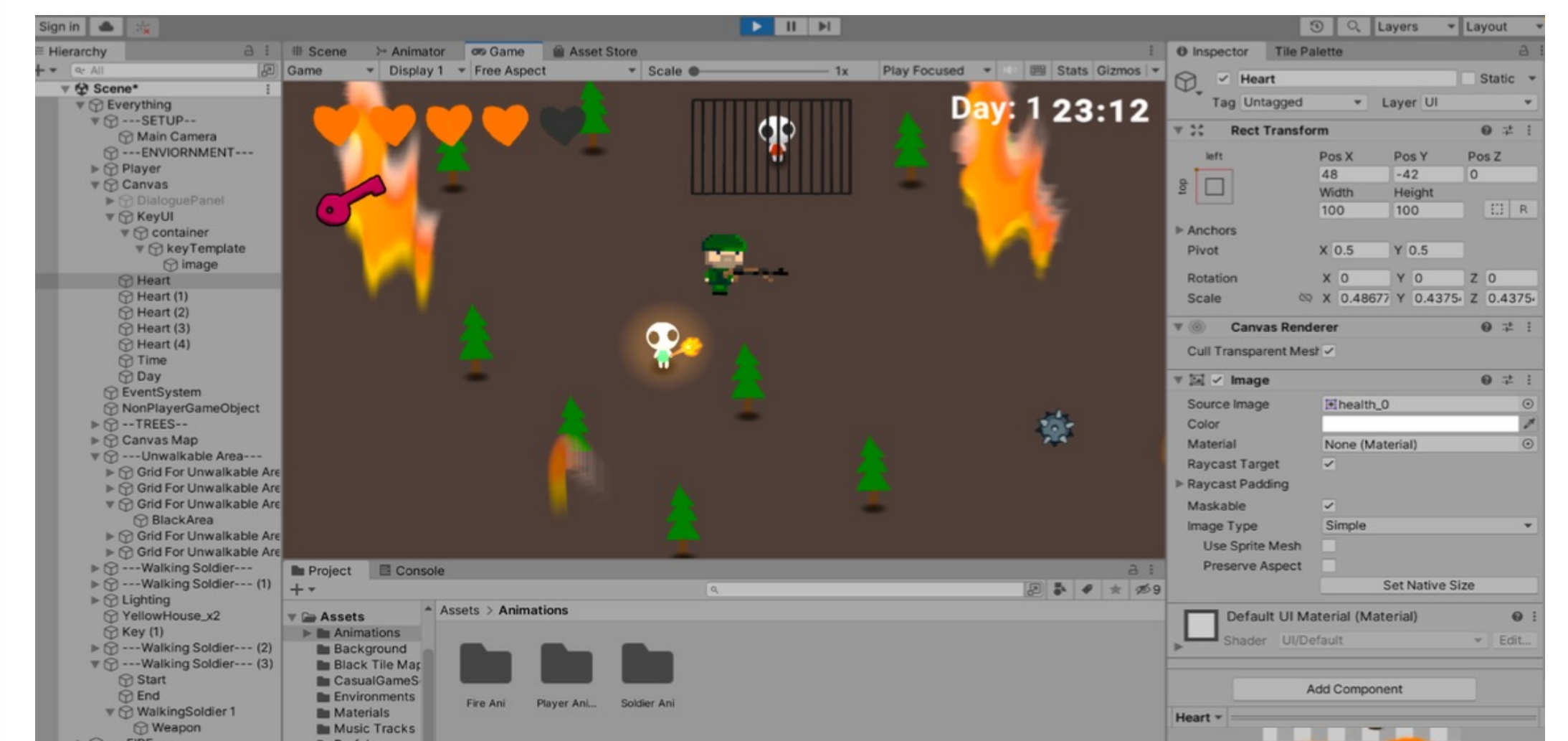


Figure 7: showcasing the imprisonment of an innocent civilian

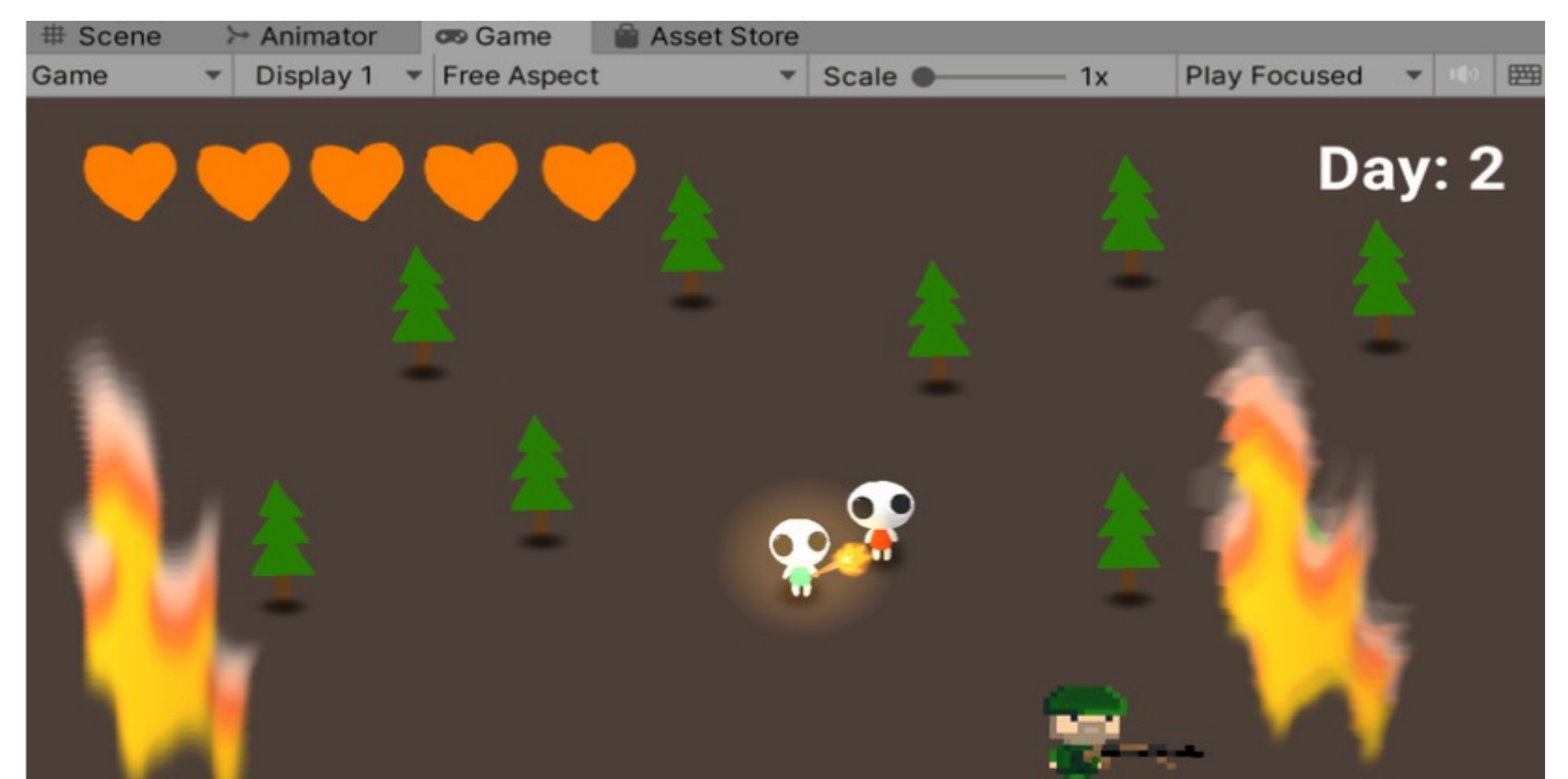


Figure 8: showcasing that the successful rescue of the imprisoned civilian by the player (another civilian), resulting in their freedom

References

- [1] Counting Myanmar's dead: Reported civilian casualties since the 2021 military coup. Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO). (n.d.).
- [2] Hsu, C. C. (2021, October 27). Myanmar Human Rights Supporters Need New Strategies. Southeast Asia Globe.
- [3] Los Angeles Times. (2021b, December 15). "my friends are being burned": Atrocities mount under Myanmar's junta. Los Angeles Times.
- [4] Bhandari, A., & Lone, W. " More than 300 people killed since Myanmar's coup." Reuters, 26 March 2021,
- [5] Nway." Revolutionary Roads: How the Army Tried to Crush Yangon's Most Anti-Coup District." The Guardian, Guardian News and Media, 6 Feb. 2022
- [6] "Blackthorn prod Game Jam #2." Learn the Art of Game Creation

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